

Year
2025

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City University of Hong Kong
楊建文學術樓
Yeung Kin Man Academic Building

ADMISSION-PEDIA

CityU/Columbia University Joint Bachelors Degree Program

Volume of
COLUMBIA

English Version



Year
2025

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2025 Edition

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Special Thanks

Columbia University in the City of New York
City University of Hong Kong Mainland Students and Scholars
Association (CSSAUG) Undergraduate Department
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College of Business, City University of Hong Kong

We hereby authorize the CityU MSSA Undergraduate Department
and the College of Business at City University of Hong Kong to
share the contents of this handbook with any interested students
to help them prepare for the program.

— Executive Editor, April 2020

We hereby authorize Columbia University to publish the link to the
"CityU-Columbia Application Resource Library" ([https://
www.cityucolumbia.com](https://www.cityucolumbia.com)), which contains the content of this
handbook, on its official website to help any interested students
prepare for the program.

— Executive Editor, November 2021

Disclaimer

This handbook was independently initiated and written by students participating in the CityU/Columbia University Joint Bachelors Degree Program. The advice provided in this handbook represents the personal opinions of the student editors and does not replace the official views of City University of Hong Kong or Columbia University. The information provided in this handbook may not reflect the most recent updates. Any Chinese terminology used in this handbook is based on personal translation for convenience; please refer to the latest official Chinese or English versions from City University of Hong Kong, Columbia University, or other relevant institutions for accuracy.

We advise all readers to take note of this statement.

Even months after starting at Columbia University, I can still clearly remember that morning in March. I usually wake up around 8:00 AM, but for some reason, I got out of bed at 5:30 AM. My phone was charging, and a notification for an unread email was waiting on the screen. The sender was Columbia University—the place that had been on my mind for so many months. Struggling with nervousness and anxiety, I lay in bed and slowly opened the notice that would determine my future. What greeted me among the many words of joy and welcome was a single "Congratulations." In that moment, a powerful sense of happiness filled my tense nerves. I literally rolled out of bed! I couldn't hold it back anymore—I had to share this exciting news with my family, my classmates, and everyone around me immediately.

As a student in the second cohort of the Computational Finance major, I know that being the first person from this major to go to Columbia University is both an honor and a responsibility. Behind this honor is the full support of the teachers at the CityU College of Business and my own hard work over time. The responsibility, on the other hand, represents the commitment to my own continuous progress and the mission to pave the way and gather experience for my fellow students. I remember when I first joined CityU, I received a guidebook called "CityU-pedia" written by the CityU Mainland Students and Scholars Union (CSSAUG). The explanations of various preparations and requirements before admission helped me a lot and made me feel well-cared for as I started my university life. I also remember that before being admitted to Columbia, although I received careful guidance from the CityU Global Engagement Office and the College of Business, I still felt uneasy. As a student in the first group of Computational Finance majors with the chance to join this program, I had to face that anxiety without advice from peers in my own major.

Therefore, I have tried to list my own preparation process and organize my personal reflections into the first draft of this manual. My goal is to allow students who are preparing for, or who want to learn about this program, to directly access the experiences of their seniors. With the kind help of other students in the program, more personal stories have been included, and the content has been continuously improved. The vision I had when I started this manual is now becoming a reality. I sincerely hope that this Senior's Advice, filled with good intentions, can light the way for your preparation. I hope it helps you manage your time more effectively, create better plans, and gain a deeper understanding of your own experiences and qualities during the process.

Best wishes to all of you, my dear and lucky juniors!

Chief Editor: Jiangtian (Joey) Hou
December 1, 2019

How time flies! Five years have already passed.

Five years ago, when I wrote the preface for the previous edition, I could never have imagined my current path. Back then, I was studying Computational Finance at the CityU College of Business. Eventually, I chose Computer Science—an engineering major—at Columbia University, went on to earn a Master’s degree in Computer Science from UC Berkeley, and have now transitioned from student life to a career writing code every day in Silicon Valley. If I told my younger self about all these decisions, I probably would have found it hard to believe. Yet, it was the step-by-step choices I made back then that shaped who I am today.

Over these five years, batch after batch of new students have been admitted to this program, arrived at Columbia, graduated, and moved on to the next chapters of their lives. Everyone faces their own set of questions: Should I pursue further studies, like a Master’s or even a PhD? Or is it time to start a new phase and embrace a professional career? Should I stay in the familiar and bustling New York City, move to other parts of the U.S., or return to Hong Kong, Mainland China, my hometown, or even somewhere else in the world? Should I continue in the field I’ve studied since CityU, or venture into the unknown and try something completely new?

Five years later, a new cohort of students is about to arrive in the U.S. in just a few months. This reminds me of my own interview at Columbia. When asked about my plans after graduation if I were admitted, I had prepared two possible answers. However, the life I am living now matches neither of them. I chose a path I had never even imagined!

Every student who has gone through this program has made their own choices when facing these questions: some have stayed true to their original goals and pushed forward through hard work; some have thought long and hard before deciding to dive into a brand-new field; and some have discovered inner conflicts, feeling hesitant and wishing for more time to reflect.

No matter the choice, it is precious, because the process of choosing brings you one step closer to yourself. The CityU/ Columbia University Joint Bachelors Degree Program provides us with the confidence and ability to explore our inner selves through the distinct teaching styles of two universities, the unique experiences of living and studying in two locations, and the vastly different cultural atmospheres of two cities. Who am I? Who do I want to become? Such questions might have been difficult to answer five years ago, and they remain hard to answer quickly today. However, I believe that the experiences of living and studying at CityU and Columbia, in Hong Kong and New York, have made the answers in my mind a little clearer.

I hope this Admission-pedia will make the transition into this new life a bit faster and more convenient for students who are pondering these same questions—or for those who are simply curious about their present and future.

Keep going and best of luck, my dear and fortunate juniors!

Chief Editor: Jiangtian (Joey) Hou
March 24, 2025

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Task Checklist

◆ **Receive the Admission Email**

Admission emails are typically sent around 5:00 PM Eastern Time on the Friday closest to March 15th. In case you do not receive an email, you can check your status on the Application Portal. You will also receive your Columbia University ID (CUID) at this time.

◆ **Accept Admission Online** ▶ Section 2: After Admission◆ **Complete Vaccination Requirements** ▶ Section 3: Vaccinations and Medical Exams◆ **Apply for Form I-20** ▶ Section 4: U.S. Entry Documents◆ **Apply for U.S. F-1 Student Visa** ▶ Section 4: U.S. Entry Documents◆ **Submit Supplemental Scholarship Materials** ▶ Section 5: Scholarships◆ **Submit Columbia Housing Application** ▶ Section 6: Housing◆ **Receive UNI and Columbia Email Address**

The UNI is your username for almost all of Columbia's online systems. It usually consists of your initials followed by a few digits.

◆ **Choose Major and Register for Classes** ▶ Section 7: Choosing Majors and Courses◆ **Prepare for Departure to the U.S.** ▶ Section 8: Tuition & Meal Plans

Columbia University typically starts the fall semester in early September.

Useful Links

School of General Studies (GS) Official Website:

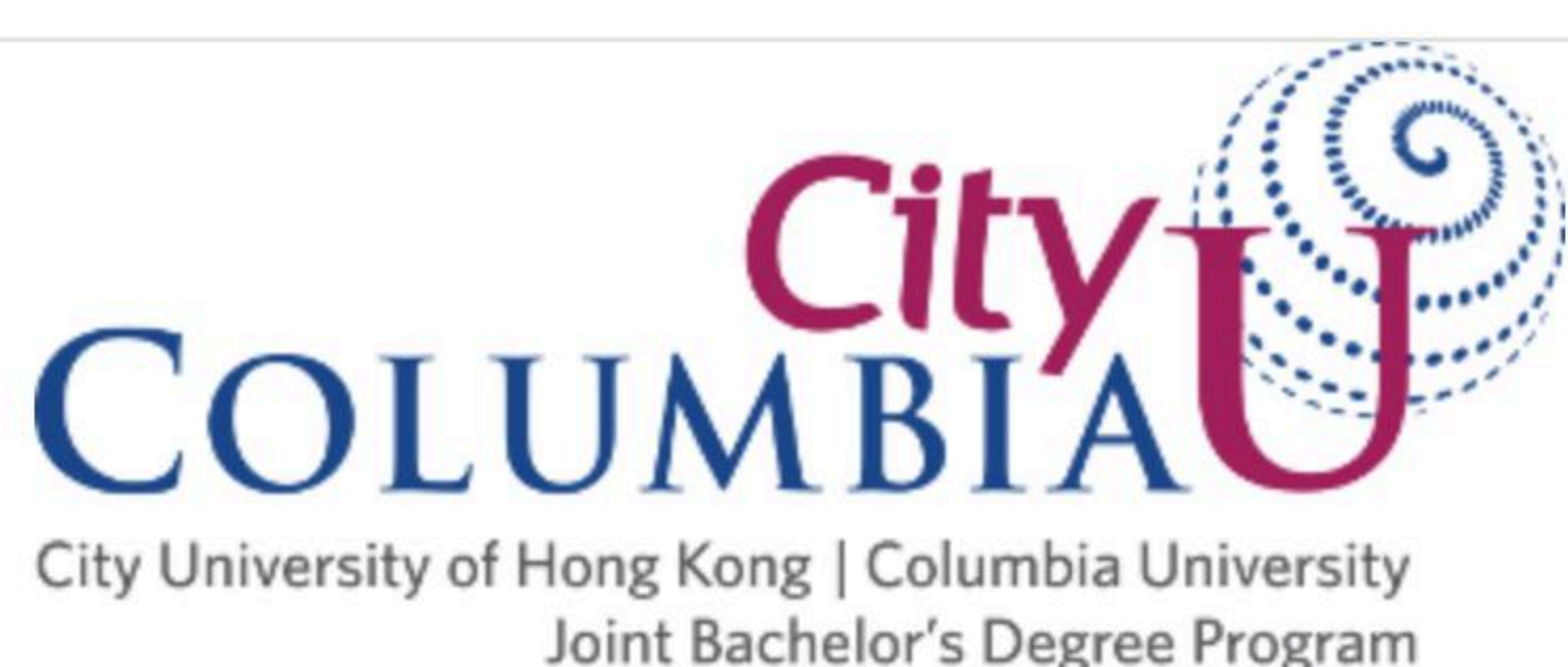
<https://gs.columbia.edu>

CityU/Columbia University Joint Bachelors Degree Program Official Website (Admitted Student Information):

<https://cityu-hk.gs.columbia.edu/content/once-admitted>

WikiCU (Columbia University's own wiki—please distinguish this from Wikipedia):

<https://www.wikicu.com>



Joey Hou Logout

Welcome, Jiangtian Hou

If you need to contact us regarding your application, provide your name and this reference number:

Status Update

An update to your application was last posted March 15, 2019.

[View Update >>](#)**Has your online application portal been updated?****If you have been admitted, congratulations! Amidst the excitement, please don't forget that there is still a series of tasks to complete before your departure.**

Online Admission Portal

Columbia University will open an **Online Admission Portal** for successful applicants. In the period leading up to the start of the semester, you can complete all necessary preparations through this platform. The left side of the portal will display your admission letter, scholarship information, required tasks, and other relevant details. Once a task is completed and confirmed by the university, the red cross will turn into a green checkmark.

Students must confirm their admission on the platform by selecting "I agree to be admitted to Columbia University." At the same time, a \$500 enrollment deposit must be paid to secure your spot.

**Senior's Advice**

After submitting the required forms or registering for activities, it may take a few days for the system to update. During this time, your task status on the portal will not change, but there is no need to resubmit the forms.

ALP Exam

If you feel that your initial ALP writing exam score was not ideal, you can take a second exam organized by the university before the term starts. Your final ALP level will be determined by the highest score among all the exams you have taken.

3

Vaccinations and Medical Exams

The content on this page is based on the situation of students from Mainland China. Students from Hong Kong and other regions should use this information for reference at their own discretion.

Vaccinations

Students enrolling at Columbia University must ensure they have received certain required vaccines. Please refer to the immunization requirements on your personal admission portal to check if you meet the standards and complete the immunization form. Students who do not meet the requirements must get vaccinated at a qualified hospital.



Senior's Advice

Columbia's admission letter clearly states that you can only register for classes one month after submitting your completed vaccine form. Considering that some vaccines cannot be taken at the same time and require long intervals between doses, I suggest checking your vaccination records as soon as you receive your offer and booking any missing shots immediately.

Experience Sharing

Lezhi Ma (Math), Enrolled in 2022

Generally, it's recommended to get your shots in Shenzhen, as private vaccines in Hong Kong are much more expensive than in the Mainland. However, Shenzhen might experience shortages, so you may need to travel to nearby cities (be mentally prepared for some minor trouble).

Jianbo He (Mathematics), Enrolled in 2023

If you haven't been vaccinated before, the only mandatory vaccines are two doses of MMR (Measles, Mumps, and Rubella), which must be administered at least 28 days apart.

Medical Exams

Before heading to the U.S., students from Mainland China need to obtain the **International Certificate of Health Examination** and the **International Certificate of Vaccination or Prophylaxis**. These two documents can be processed for a fee at International Travel Healthcare Centers in various regions.



Senior's Advice

The health examination and vaccination certificates (the "Red Book" and the "Yellow Book") may be needed when entering the U.S. Additionally, these two books serve as official records of your vaccinations and health checks in the U.S., which is very useful.

Experience Sharing

Lezhi Ma (Math), Enrolled in 2022

While the Red and Yellow Books are not strictly mandatory for Columbia, they are required by immigration laws. Although there is only a small chance they will be checked at border control, it's better to be safe and get them done since they are mostly free.

About the Red Book: This is essentially your physical exam report. The exam must be completed at designated hospitals and requires an appointment in advance. In Shenzhen, this is usually at the "Shenzhen International Travel Healthcare Center" near the Luohu Port. You need to grab an appointment slot on their WeChat official account at a specific time every day, and the report takes 5 business days to be issued—so make sure to leave enough time! If your study period is longer than a year, the basic exam is free. Remember to show your I-20 form during payment to waive the fee. You can search on Xiaohongshu/RedNote for more specific details about the exam.

About the Yellow Book: This is the international version of your vaccination record. It can also be obtained at the Shenzhen International Travel Healthcare Center, but they usually only issue it if you get vaccinated there. If you didn't get your shots there, you can ask them to print a yellow vaccination sheet that has the same legal effect (it looks similar to the ones from community health centers but includes an official quarantine stamp).

Notes:

The “Red Book”: International Certificate of Health Examination.

The “Yellow Book”: International Certificate of Vaccination or Prophylaxis.

Useful Links

Vaccination requirements on the Columbia University website:

<https://www.health.columbia.edu/immunization-compliance-office>

(International Travel Health Care Association) Directory of International Travel Health Care Centers:

<http://www.itha.org.cn/gdbjzx/bjzx.htm>

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U.S. Entry Documents

All students participating in the CityU/Columbia University Joint Bachelors Degree Program must obtain a U.S. F-1 student visa and a Form I-20 issued by the university before entering the United States. Each time you enter the U.S., you will need to present your valid passport, F-1 visa, and Form I-20.

Form I-20

For this program, the **Form I-20** is issued by the Columbia International Students and Scholars Office (ISSO) and is used to apply for an F-1 student visa. You must present your I-20 when you first arrive in the U.S. and whenever you return to the U.S. from abroad during the program.

For details on the preparation process and important notes regarding the I-20, please refer to the Columbia University website.



Senior's Advice

The university is responsible for issuing the Form I-20. Students can submit their information and pay the application fee through the links provided by Columbia.

F-1 Student Visa

The **F-1 student visa** can be obtained at a U.S. Embassy or Consulate. For the application process, you can refer to the "New Student Handbook" (updated annually) published on the official WeChat account of the Columbia University Chinese Students and Scholars Association (CUCSSA), as well as other online resources.



Senior's Advice

Students need to handle the F-1 visa application themselves. Please make sure to allow plenty of time for preparation. Note that you cannot apply more than 365 days before the program starts.

Experience Sharing

Jianbo He (Mathematics), Enrolled in 2023

The summer break is the peak season for visa applications, so I recommend completing the process as early as possible.

Useful Links

Columbia University I-20 Application Process:

<https://isso.columbia.edu/content/applying-your-i-20ds-2019>

U.S. Visa Information Service for China – Student Visa Overview:

<https://www.ustraveldocs.com/cn/zh/student-visa>

F-1 Student Visa Application Process (Zhihu):

<https://zhuanlan.zhihu.com/p/35223146>

Scholarships

CityU Scholarships

CityU provides various scholarships for students admitted to the program. These scholarships are awarded annually from the time you move to the U.S. until the end of your senior year. The amount is typically several tens of thousands of Hong Kong dollars per year.

Additionally, students who received the CityU Entrance Scholarship upon admission can continue to receive the same amount in the U.S., provided they meet the renewal requirements. Please note that while students may choose to study at Columbia for more than two years, the CityU Entrance Scholarship is only distributed until the end of the senior year.



Senior's Advice

1. CityU scholarships target different groups—for example, some are for local students only, while others are open to everyone. Please check the eligibility requirements carefully before applying.
2. Detailed scholarship information is sent via university emails. You must submit your applications individually after receiving the notification.

Columbia Financial Aid

When applying for the program, students have already completed the **Columbia financial aid** application. You do not need to submit financial proof before the admission results are released. Financial aid decisions are typically sent out along with the admission letters. Students are required to submit supporting financial documents after receiving their offer.



Senior's Advice

The financial aid application includes a detailed survey of personal and family assets. Consult your parents and ensure you fill it out honestly and carefully.

Experience Sharing

Lezhi Ma (Math), Enrolled in 2022

Columbia financial aid must be applied for every year; each award covers one academic year.

Useful Links

Scholarship information on the CityU/Columbia University Joint Bachelors Degree Program website:

<https://cityu-hk.gs.columbia.edu/content/financial-aid>

Scholarship information on the Columbia GS website:

<https://www.gs.columbia.edu/content/applying-aid-prospective-undergraduate-students>

Applying for Housing

There are many residential buildings around the Columbia campus managed by **Columbia Residential**. The university guarantees that students admitted to the CityU/Columbia University Joint Bachelors Degree Program will have access to university housing throughout their period of study at Columbia.

Before the official process begins, students can submit their housing applications and specific requirements through the **Housing Portal**. These requirements include whether you need a furnished room, preferences for specific buildings, or requests to live with certain classmates. After submitting your personal information and preliminary application, you will receive emails regarding the different application windows.

Before the application period officially opens, you should browse the available addresses and room conditions on your own. When the formal application starts, you must submit your room preferences within the designated timeframe. The university will assign housing based on the time of submission and your list of preferences.

Once results are released, you can check your rent, floor plans, and roommate information on the Housing Portal. Afterward, you will need to sign a lease agreement with the landlord (the University), pay a deposit, and confirm your move-in date. Leases can be renewed at the end of each academic year.



Senior's Advice

1. Before applying for housing, you can use Google Maps or other map services to explore the area around Columbia. Pay attention to subway stations, supermarkets, restaurants, and the walking distance to campus. When choosing a room, consider the following:
 - a. The location and floor of the building;
 - b. Room type and size;
 - c. Whether the rent fits your budget;
 - d. Essential facilities like furniture and elevators;
 - e. Whether there is a doorman.
2. Since the selection platform is only open during the specific application period, it is highly recommended to attend the housing information sessions in advance to prepare your strategy.

Experience Sharing

Lezhi Ma (Math), Enrolled in 2022

Housing must be "snagged" on the platform right when it opens, as competition is very intense. I personally felt that the filtering system on the platform had some issues; sometimes applying a filter would show "no matching results." I suggest not relying too much on the filter function. It's better to identify your preferred building names beforehand, lock onto a building as soon as the window opens, and then pick a room.

In my experience, apartment rent is closely related to room size: if the common areas are large but the bedrooms are small, the rent generally tends to be cheaper.

Yuhan Zhang (East Asian Studies), Enrolled in 2022

In 2025, the rent for university apartments near Columbia (Morningside Heights) was generally between \$1,400 and \$1,800 per month (for a private bedroom with a shared living room, kitchen, and bathroom). A more affordable option is a shared double room in a dorm, but even those usually cost over \$1,000 per person per month.

Columbia also has housing in the Bronx. Apartment prices there are around \$1,400 per month, while shared rooms are about \$900 per person. There is a free shuttle bus that runs regularly between the campus and the Bronx. The housing is located in a wealthier part of the Bronx, which is relatively safer than other areas in that borough.

◆ Siyi Xu (Global Business), Enrolled in 2022

If you can't find suitable housing, you can set your application preference to "Gender Neutral." This will give you more options to choose from.

◆ Jiangtian Hou (Computational Finance), Enrolled in 2017

The university offers various room types, and prices vary significantly. Generally, living alone is more expensive than sharing a room; the more private space you have, the higher the cost. Housing fees can be charged by semester or by month (requirements may differ depending on the specific residence hall).

Transferring Housing

If you wish to change the room you were assigned before enrollment, you can move to a new room or building by submitting a **transfer** application.

Columbia offers two ways to transfer housing. There is a coordinated opportunity to apply for a transfer once every Fall and Spring semester, known as a **General Transfer**. During other times of the year, you can also move directly to another room through a **Direct Transfer**.

Experience Sharing

◆ Yuhan Zhang (East Asian Studies), Enrolled in 2022

You can apply for a Direct Transfer all year round. As long as you know which room is about to become available, you can move in once the previous resident moves out. General Transfer applications are open every February and October, giving you a two-day window to decide which room to switch to.

◆ Jiangtian Hou (Computational Finance), Enrolled in 2017

Columbia's residence halls have a wide variety of layouts, and even rooms within the same building can differ greatly. Since students may not be familiar with the floor plans of every building, it is best to prepare in advance if you want to transfer. You can check with fellow students to see if anyone is moving out during the transfer period, then look into the layout and environment of that room. Alternatively, you can keep an eye on available rooms on the Columbia Residential website. Identify buildings where you know people living there to get familiar with the room types, and then apply for a Direct Transfer.

Useful Links

Columbia Residential Website:

<https://residential.columbia.edu/>

Housing Portal:

<https://residential.cuf.columbia.edu/>

Information on Transferring:

<https://residential.columbia.edu/content/transferring>

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Choosing Majors and Courses

Choosing a Major

One month after the start of each semester, there is a **major declaration period** that lasts for one month. After consulting with advisors from both CityU and Columbia University, students can choose their major at Columbia, provided they meet the graduation requirements of the program.

Experience Sharing

Lezhi Ma (Math), Enrolled in 2022

Columbia does not require you to declare a major in your first semester, but it is best to do so early if you have a plan. Once declared, you will be added to the email list for your department or college, allowing you to receive notifications about seminars and other events.

Choosing Courses

Currently, Columbia's course registration platform is **Vergil**. Students can design their course plans after speaking with their academic advisors and then register on Vergil according to the schedule.



Senior's Advice

Different majors and colleges at CityU have different standards for transferring credits between the two universities. To ensure you can complete the degree requirements for both schools on time, please consult with the person in charge of your major or college in advance to confirm if your course plan is feasible.

Experience Sharing

Lezhi Ma (Math), Enrolled in 2022

You can find the courses offered each semester on the Columbia University Directory of Classes. For instructor reviews, you can check Vergil, the CULPA website (where reviews are posted anonymously), or forums like Reddit.

Ying Wang (Computer Science), Enrolled in 2022

To maintain your F-1 visa status as a full-time student, you must enroll in at least 12 credits per semester.

Useful Links

Columbia University Directory of Classes:

<https://doc.sis.columbia.edu/>

Columbia University Liaison on Professors and Academic Affairs (CULPA):

<https://culpa.info/>

Tuition and Meal Plans

Tuition

Tuition is determined by the number of course credits you take each semester. Generally, the price is approximately \$2,000 per credit. When Columbia prepares your I-20 form (required for entry into the U.S.), the university will provide an official estimate of tuition and living expenses. Before the semester begins, students must check their electronic bill (E-bill) on the Columbia system. This bill includes tuition, housing, dining (such as meal plans), administrative and student service fees, insurance, and other costs.



Senior's Advice

1. As a full-time student, you must take at least 12 credits per semester.
2. Tuition is capped at the price of 16 credits. This means:
 - If you take 16 credits or fewer, your tuition = number of credits × price per credit.
 - If you take more than 16 credits, you will only be charged the tuition for 16 credits.

Experience Sharing

◆ **Jianbo He (Mathematics), Enrolled in 2023**

In 2025, tuition rose to \$2,188 per credit. Please note: tuition typically increases by about 5% every year.

Dining Fees

The university offers discounted dining options called **meal plans**. Once purchased, you simply swipe your student ID card to enter the various campus dining halls; the cost or meal count is deducted automatically, so no additional payment is needed at the door.

Columbia University and the School of General Studies (GS) offer their own separate meal plans. There may be differences in the cost per meal, the number of meals per package, and other benefits.

Meal plans are generally purchased in two ways: by meal count or by dollar amount. Students can either buy a set number of meals at once (e.g., 100 meals) or add a specific dollar balance (e.g., \$1,000).



Senior's Advice

If you do not finish your meal plan by the end of the fall semester, the remaining balance cannot be carried over to the spring semester. Therefore, be sure to plan carefully before purchasing and check your remaining balance frequently.

Experience Sharing

◆ **Lezhi Ma (Math), Enrolled in 2022**

If you receive a Columbia scholarship, you will automatically receive an invitation to join the GS Meal Plan. However, even if you don't have a scholarship, you can still use the invitation link to access the GS Meal Plan website (Between us: this seems like a bit of a loophole!).

The GS Meal Plan (about \$9.25 per meal) is much cheaper than Columbia's other meal plans (which are around \$15 per meal).

◆ **Lezhi Ma (Math), Enrolled in 2022 (Cont.)**

The GS Meal Plan allows you to buy 50, 75, or 100 meals at a time, and you can add more on the website later if needed. In contrast, standard Columbia Dining plans usually start at 100 meals and often include a small amount of "Flex" or "Dining Dollars" for more flexible spending.

◆ **Jiangtian Hou (Computational Finance), Enrolled in 2017**

Once you sign up for a meal plan, it remains valid for one year and you will be automatically charged once per semester. Here is an example to show how it works:

Suppose you choose a meal plan that offers 100 meals per semester at a rate of \$9.25 per meal. If you select this plan before the Fall semester starts, you will have 100 meal swipes available for both the Fall and the Spring semesters.

Before the Fall semester begins, the university will charge you for one semester's meals, totaling \$925 ($100 \times \9.25). You will have 100 swipes for the Fall semester; however, suppose you only use 70 of them.

Before the Spring semester, you will be charged the same amount (\$925) as in the Fall. You will still have 100 swipes for the Spring semester. Any unused swipes from the Fall (in this case, $100 - 70 = 30$ swipes) will be forfeited and cannot be refunded.

Useful Links

- GS Campus Dining Information:**
<https://gs.columbia.edu/content/campus-dining>
- Columbia Dining Information:**
<https://dining.columbia.edu/content/dining-plans>
- GS Meal Plan Details (Requires UNI login):**
<https://gs-columbia.my.site.com/community/s/meal-plan>
- Columbia Student Dining Plans:**
<https://dining.columbia.edu/student-dining-plans>

Afterword

The 2025 CityU/Columbia University Joint Bachelors Degree Program Admission-pedia: Volume of Columbia (hereinafter referred to as the "2025 Edition") was spearheaded and edited by Jiangtian Hou, a student enrolled in 2017. Built upon the 2019 version, this edition was compiled and published with the support of Columbia University, the Undergraduate Department of the Chinese Students and Scholars Association of City University of Hong Kong (CSSAUG), and the CityU College of Business.

Five editors enrolled in 2017 expanded the content of the original 2019 manual. Faculty members from the CityU College of Business and the program provided dedicated guidance and valuable suggestions during the initial writing and revision process. Supported by CSSAUG, the 2019 manual was completed in three languages (Simplified Chinese, Traditional Chinese, and English) and promoted via the CSSAUG WeChat platform. Since 2021, the manual has been available for download on the "CityU-Columbia Application Resource Library" website (<https://www.cityucolumbia.com>).

Since 2025, Lezhi Ma (Enrolled in 2022) has played a key role in coordinating the revisions and providing essential feedback. Several editors enrolled in 2022 and 2023 contributed significantly to this latest update. Specifically, Jianbo He (Enrolled in 2023) worked on Sections 1 and 2; Hengche Liu (Enrolled in 2023) and Yixian Liu (Enrolled in 2023) contributed to the F-1 student visa content in Section 4; Lezhi Ma contributed to Sections 2, 5, 7, and 8, as well as the Senior's Advice in Sections 3, 6, and 8, and Useful Links in Sections 7 and 8; Yuhan Zhang (Enrolled in 2022) assisted with the housing application content in Section 6. Siyi Xu (Enrolled in 2022), Ying Wang (Enrolled in 2022), and other editors provided comprehensive assistance for the Experience Sharing sections throughout the manual. We would like to express our sincere gratitude to all the student editors.

Jiangtian Hou revised parts of the main text and various sections for the 2025 Edition, while also handling the graphic design, editing, and proofreading.

We sincerely welcome feedback from teachers, students, and parents. We will continue to gather ideas and update this manual to ensure it remains a helpful resource.

Editors
March 24, 2025

Useful Links

CityU Columbia Resources (Non-official website):
<https://www.cityucolumbia.com>

2025 Edition

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